Dream within a Dream | Dead but Dreaming

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/60412276.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Assassin's Creed - All Media Types

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Part 2 of Blade in the Crowd

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by Ogjnogth

Summary

Adora tries to come to terms with revelations regarding her nature

Epilogue to Blade in the Crowd. You could probably technically read it without, but it might be hilariously incomprehensible without background.

Notes

After, uhhh. This week. Needed to put something down here. Plus I can't really think about anything new without getting this out of the way.

Anyway, whether you liked my story or just needed cute lesbians after this week, here you go.

See the end of the work for more notes

She could still feel the shocks coursing through her body.

The searing pain as two minds became one.

Two minds…

Had they ever truly been two minds?

For years she had struggled with her dreams altering her view of the world.

But were they the dream, or was this life?

Adora, orphaned girl, taken in by a Templar esotericist, now a member of the Assassin Brotherhood.

Aurora, daughter of Juno and Aita, two of the greatest scientific minds the Isu had ever seen.

Who's to say who she really was?

When she was in the machine, and her own face looked back at her, spoke in her own voice… who's to say that her doppelgänger was not the real her?

———

Adora sat up in her bed, exhausted but unable to make her mind stop spinning.

The spot beside her was empty— Angella had urged them to take a break after the incident in the First Civilization temple, but within a few days Catra was going stir crazy, and had resumed activity within the Brotherhood.

Adora, on the other hand… she had barely been able to sleep.

Not that that was out of the ordinary— the surrounding areas had been plagued by crippling nightmares since the temple was opened, a few members of the bureau suggesting that the stirring

of the guardian beast may have been responsible. But those were different, dreams of mysterious temples, alien tongues, horrible creatures beyond description. Nothing like the uncanny familiarity that kept Adora awake.

She shifted over to her nightstand, and its locked drawer. Fumbling around to find the key, she eventually opened the drawer, and pulled out the strange Precursor disc which had operated the ruin.

The strange, unnerving book that Weaver had used to find the temple was thankfully destroyed, but this strange item remained—shining an eerie gold, the warped pentagram still beckoning.

Placing the disc back into the drawer for safekeeping, Adora stood from her bed, and headed out of her bedroom.

Angella had made tea for her that night early on when she was struggling with her dreams; that tea could hopefully help settle her again.

As she boiled the water for the tea, she breathed in some of the hot fumes, trying to calm her body. When the kettle was ready, she poured the water into the milk and tea leaves, stirring the liquid before pouring it into a cup, holding the hot porcelain teaware as it cooled and placing it on a side table in her small sitting room.

The routine of it all was grounding, in a way. To think about the here and now and ignore the growing uncertainty of if it really was here and now.

A swooping noise moved towards the apartment's window, causing Adora to instinctively turn, albeit less alertly than would probably be ideal.

The window was slid open, and a black-and-red cloaked figure emerged. The figure then dropped their hood, revealing the face of the woman she had loved all her life... or longer.

“Hey, Adora,” the girl softly drawled. “Dreams again?”

Adora grimaced and reached for her tea, taking a sip of the warm drink before muttering, “No, haven’t been able to sleep at all.” She then forced a smile, asking her lover, “How was your mission?”

Catra plopped down into the soft chair opposite the blonde, clearly tired from her night, and most likely life in general. “Honestly, fairly average target. Some evil capitalist with Templar money in his pockets. Basically just walked in the mill front door and up to his office.” The brunette Assassin snickered quietly to herself. “Amusing how many people will see a hooded person walk determinedly through a crowd and just assume they belong there.”

Adora laughed at Catra’s remark— no matter how many times she herself had experienced it, it never ceased to amaze her what people could just ignore.

“But the Templars are back around here?”

Catra groaned into her hands. “Yeah. Honestly that thing you said Hordak said to you, about the hydra… yeah, definitely. Plus the Kurs and Weaver… Netossa dug through the grandmaster’s files. Apparently the other Templars weren’t terribly amused by the infighting, or the mad search for Precursor artifacts based on the ramblings of a ninth century nutcase. People were telling Annilis to have her killed. If she had taken a little longer, we hadn’t been captured, he might have given in.”

The Assassin stretched, before stating, “Either way, now that the blatantly dysfunctional Rite we know and love is dead, others have stepped in. Way less interested in Precursor occultism, so that’s a plus I guess, but really into labor abuse, the gold standard…”

Catra’s exhaustion gave way to a soft look as she asked, “Are you doing okay?”

Adora shifted uncomfortably before muttering, “I don’t know. I don’t know if I ever was.”

Catra leaned over to her lover’s chair, pulling her into a soft embrace. She quietly spoke, “When we were in the temple… the shock, confusion, sudden memories of a life I had never lived… it was almost paralyzing. Like if it weren’t for pure instinct I would have just sat there and watched. Thinking that you’ve been handling those all our lives… I know it’s nothing in comparison, but believe me when I say, you’re so strong.”

Adora held back a sob, whispering, barely audible, “Am I? Or is Aurora?”

Catra pulled back, staring deeply into Adora’s baby blue eyes. “Yes. Yes you are. She said it herself. You are not her.”

Tears were beginning to drip from the blonde Assassin’s eyes. “Still? The Relay machine-“

“-Is broken.” Catra responded forcefully. Noticing her harsh tone, she quickly softened, murmuring, “It can’t hurt you anymore. Aurora and Astra saved us. And maybe you were supposed to be Aurora, but you aren’t. You are you, Adora, and if I have to remind you every day of every week for the rest of my life I will.”

Adora leaned into the crook of the girl’s neck, letting out the held back tears, as Catra stroked her fingers through her long blonde hair. “Shhh… it’s okay princess. I’m not letting go.”

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End Notes

Fucking Abstergo

Be safe out there!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!